

EVIDENCE CARD

What works, and how we know

The mission's checked research in one place: vocational orientation and technical secondary for MINEDU, youth employment for the MTPE, financing for Pronabec. Each case in two sentences: how it works, and what it delivered. Every figure verified against the primary source linked at the end.



§ 01 ·

WHY THIS CARD

On 30 August, viceministra de Gestión Pedagógica **Miriam Ponce** published the sector's working agenda: update the curriculum, **strengthen technical secondary**, align CETPRO and institutes with productive demand, and **reinforce vocational orientation** and the COAR. The same Saturday, she shared a stage with viceminister **Juan Carlos Paz** at the Es Hoy forum on youth employment. This card carries the evidence for those conversations.

§ 02 ·

VOCATIONAL ORIENTATION: THE CHEAP LEVER

Peru, MineduLAB: Decidiendo para un Futuro Mejor. Cómo funciona: the ministry's own innovation lab, with IPA, showed short videos on the real returns to finishing school, inside class hours, right before students decide. **Impacto:** lower dropout at a marginal cost of **S/ 0,20 per student**, with the potential to keep more than 25,000 students in school, and better ECE mathematics scores in Junín and Áncash. **This ministry already proved the idea;** the AI career coach is the same idea, ten years on.

Dominican Republic (Jensen, QJE 2010). Cómo funciona: students dramatically underestimated what finishing school pays; the trial simply told them the measured returns. **Impacto:** more completed years of schooling from information alone. The founding result behind every returns-information programme since.

Mexico, returns information in upper secondary (Avitabile and de Hoyos). Cómo funciona: a randomised trial gave students facts on returns and on how to finance further study. **Impacto:** mathematics learning rose by about a tenth of a standard deviation: students who see why school pays work harder at it.

§ 03 ·

TECHNICAL SECONDARY: THE DESIGNS THAT DELIVERED

Korea, Meister high schools. Cómo funciona: 52 technical schools designed with industry inside: firms co-write the curriculum, practitioners teach, and hiring agreements are part of the model. **Impacto:** graduate employment above **90% in 2013 to 2017**, and still the top of the system: 73,1% employed against 52,4% for specialised schools and 38,2% for vocational tracks in general schools, with the best one-year job retention (71,5%).

Switzerland and Germany, the dual system. Cómo funciona: students split the week between classroom and a paid apprenticeship in a firm, across 250 occupations; the firm is a co-educator, not a destination. **Impacto:** two thirds of Swiss young people choose this route, and Switzerland holds one of the lowest youth unemployment rates in the OECD. The lesson that travels is the design, not the wealth.

Mexico, CONALEP's dual model. Cómo funciona: the German design adapted to a middle-income system since 2013: alternance between school and firm under formal agreements between colleges and companies. **Impacto:** dual-track students show **better grades, attendance, completion and university admission** than the traditional track. Proof the dual idea survives translation to Latin America.

§ 04 ·

YOUTH EMPLOYMENT, FOR THE MTPE ROOM

The honest opener (McKenzie, World Bank Research Observer). Across the trials on training, wage subsidies and job search, **most active labour-market policies deliver much less than assumed.**

Colombia, Jóvenes en Acción (Attanasio, Kugler and Meghir). Cómo funciona: three months of technical classroom training plus three months of in-firm practice, private providers paid for placement. **Impacto:** sustained gains in formal employment and earnings, around **20% for women**, persisting years later; the regional benchmark.

Peru, ProJoven: the MTPE's own precedent. Cómo funciona: the direct ancestor of Jóvenes Productivos: short technical courses plus guaranteed in-firm practice, targeted at low-income urban youth. **Impacto:** evaluations found higher earnings and formal employment, with the largest gains for young women. The evidence for this design lives inside the viceminister's own ministry.

Beyond information: the published Peru trial (WB blog, July 2026). Cómo funciona: information campaigns show mixed results because **information arrives generic while the questions are personal**; mentoring works where information and even cash do not, but cannot scale. The Eligiendo Mi Camino trial closes that gap with an AI coach that interviews each student, corrects myths and helps prepare the conversation at home: 100+ public schools, 6,000 students. **Impacto:** career readiness up **0,12 standard deviations**, beliefs about technical earnings corrected by about **21%**, intentions to enrol in a technical institute up **14%**, at **about a dollar per student**: mentoring at the cost of information.

§ 05 ·

THE ES HOY PROPOSALS, FROM THE PAZ AND PONCE FORUM

EncontrarNos por el Perú (Es Hoy and Apoyo Consultoría) published four proposals for the first hundred days: a **tax incentive for the first formal youth job**; **dual training** designed with firms; **strengthening Mi Carrera**, the MTPE's career-information platform; and **scholarships by taxes** channelled through Pronabec. Two are doors this mission can walk through: Mi Carrera is the natural home for **Gallito at scale**; dual training, the technical note already offered to MINEDU.

§ 06 ·

FINANCING, FOR THE PRONABEC ROOM (CAPPES, JULY 2026)

Transition to higher education was **37,8% in 2024**, against 45,9% in Colombia and 50,5% in Chile. Scholarships cover **2,4% of enrolment**, the State's credit line is marginal (**fewer than 4,000 loans in fourteen years**, 780 active in 2025), and CAPPES estimates **917,000 students** need some financing instrument. Its proposal: short permanence credits led by the private sector, plus long-horizon access credits with state architecture; the reference already circulating in Lima.

§ 07 ·

WHAT THE BANK CAN PUT ON THE TABLE THIS WEEK

A **comparative technical note** on Meister, the dual system and CONALEP, and the design of a Peruvian pilot. A **revival of the MineduLAB orientation line**, now with AI. **Gallito at scale inside Mi Carrera** for the MTPE. And a **working session with each ministry's technical teams** to choose the entry point.

SOURCES

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6. CAPPES, Invertir en el talento, July 2026 · https://drive.google.com/file/d/1UqYj60Wmabg36Knptdu078dTA5q_pxXS/view
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8. Jensen 2010 QJE; Avitabile and de Hoyos; Attanasio, Kugler and Meghir; Ñopo and Saavedra · literature, full citations on request